



Editorial

Building on the legacy of the International Journal of Information Management



It has been a year since we assumed the role of Co-Editors-in-Chief of the *International Journal of Information Management (IJIM)*. Over the past year, we are happy to see the growth of the journal. Building on the foundation laid by the past editors-in-chief, we strive to ensure that IJIM continues to be a reputable outlet for high-quality research. IJIM has an excellent reputation and a very high impact factor, and is well known for publishing high-quality research in information systems within a reasonable timeframe. Our vision is that IJIM should continue to be the leading journal for information systems research, while embracing all other types of emerging and relevant research topics and research methods. In particular, the journal is in a perfect position to attract research related to artificial intelligence and data science, which have drawn a lot of attention and research interest in recent years.

There are several important directions that we take to achieve the vision. We will elaborate on some of these important directions in this editorial.

1. Aims and scope

One of the first things we did was to review the aims and scope of IJIM. To become a leading journal, it is important for IJIM to stay more focused on publishing high-quality papers in a discipline. The enhanced aims and scope allow the journal to focus on publishing high-impact research in the discipline of information systems, while embracing an inclusive range of topics, levels of analysis, and perspectives, especially interdisciplinary research.

The journal focuses on:

- Design, development, implementation, and management of information technologies and systems in organizational and societal contexts;
- Strategic integration of IT in business, including IT strategy, governance, and organizational change management;
- Digital innovation and emerging technologies—for example, research on social media, mobile and cloud computing, digital platforms and ecosystems, big data analytics, artificial intelligence, the Internet of Things, blockchains, and other cutting-edge technologies and their convergence;
- Organizational initiatives that enhance decision-making and business intelligence;
- Use, impact, and value of information systems on individuals, organizations, and society, including studies of how IS influences organizational performance and processes, user behavior and experience, economics of IT, and public or institutional policy;

- Organizationally contextualized ethical, social, and policy issues that are arising in the digital era (for instance, research on data privacy, security and resilience of IT infrastructures, sustainability, digital inclusion, and the societal implications of information technology).

By covering this broad spectrum of topics, IJIM provides a comprehensive forum for both theoretical advances and practical insights into contemporary information systems in business contexts.

1.1. Theoretical and methodological rigor

IJIM is committed to the highest standards of academic rigor and scholarly contribution, publishing only work that is innovative, insightful, and rigorously developed. Specifically:

- We seek papers that make strong research contributions, whether by building new theory or significantly extending existing frameworks. The journal values research that develops a scholarly understanding based on empirical evidence while also offering novel theoretical insights. Papers that do not advance theory or design in a significant way will be desk rejected. Each paper is expected to have a clear theoretical or design science grounding and to articulate its contribution to the broader IS literature, whether it be by challenging existing assumptions, integrating streams of research, unveiling new relationships and constructs, or designing new artifacts.
- We welcome diverse research methodologies and encourage authors to employ the approach best suited to their research question. Submissions may be quantitative (e.g. large-scale surveys, experiments, analytics), qualitative (e.g. case studies, ethnographies, interviews), design science (artifacts and solutions demonstrating IT innovation), or analytical/modeling studies.
- While we welcome research that draws on perspectives from computer science, management, economics, psychology, sociology, organization science, and other related disciplines, our focus is on information systems and information management. Any papers narrowly focused (e.g., marketing or agriculture) will be desk rejected.
- Novel combinations of theories or methods that address complex IS phenomena are welcomed. Regardless of approach, all submissions must demonstrate methodological rigor, sound analysis, and validity of results.

The journal ensures a rich methodological plurality that advances the IS field's knowledge base.

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1.2. Article types

We have reviewed the article types published by IJIM and organized them under four major types. Authors should choose one of the article types when submitting a paper.

- **Research Articles:** Full-length, theoretically grounded manuscripts that advance knowledge in information and management through rigorous conceptual development and empirical validation. Submissions should clearly align with the journal's scope and mission.
- **Research Methods Articles:** These articles focus on advancing the practice of doing research. This includes papers that introduce or refine methodologies (quantitative, qualitative, or computational, including AI-enabled methods), discuss innovations in data collection or analysis, or reflect on research design, theory building, and scholarly inquiry.
- **Theory and Review Articles:** These submissions offer integrative reviews of existing literature and develop frameworks that organize knowledge and guide future research. Authors are encouraged to identify gaps, evaluate theoretical contributions, and propose novel directions or conceptual models that shape the evolution of the field.
- **Research Notes:** Short-form articles that provide timely and focused contributions, such as replication studies, critical re-evaluations of past findings, or exploratory research that challenges prevailing assumptions. This category welcomes contrarian perspectives and constructive critique that fosters healthy academic debate.

1.3. A leading outlet for cutting-edge scholarship

As a premier journal in information systems and information management, IJIM aspires to publish only the highest quality scholarship in the discipline. We are dedicated to maintaining a rigorous peer-review process and upholding ethical publication standards to ensure excellence and integrity in the research we disseminate. The journal seeks out groundbreaking and forward-looking studies that push the boundaries of current knowledge and explore emerging frontiers in information systems research. Our goal is to remain at the forefront of the field, by attracting influential research that will set scholarly agendas and guide future inquiry. In line with this goal, IJIM promotes innovative and theory-driven research that is also relevant and insightful for global audiences of scholars. Through its broad scope and unwavering commitment to rigor, IJIM positions itself as a premier venue for cutting-edge IS research. We invite authors to submit their best work to IJIM, confident that our journal provides an authoritative platform to advance the state of knowledge and practice in information systems and to shape the future direction of the field.

2. Editorial and review process

Before we discuss the editorial and review process, we must thank the editors and reviewers of IJIM. They have been making tremendous contribution to maintaining the high quality of the papers published. The success of IJIM would not be possible without their diligent work.

Looking at the editorial and review process, we try our best to make sure that authors can receive fair, high-quality, and timely feedback on their submissions. Such an editorial and review process is beneficial to all parties (authors, reviewers, editors, and publisher). It is important to make sure that the editorial and review process is rigorous and timely in order to maintain the reputation of the journal.

At the same time, we need to handle a large number of submissions. There are more than 2500 submissions in each of the past 2 years. As the Co-Editors-in-Chief, we need to be prudent in deciding what papers should proceed to the next stage of the review cycle. Similar to many

other high-quality journals nowadays, IJIM desk rejects the majority of submissions. While this can avoid overburdening our associate editors and reviewers, it also provides a quick turnaround for the authors, who can resubmit the paper to a more suitable outlet.

Speed is something that we are proud of at IJIM. Papers that we consider as not a good fit for the journal or not likely to survive a full review process are desk rejected within a median of 4 days. Papers that are sent out for review will receive the first editorial decision after a median of about 65 days. For accepted papers, the median number of days from submission to receipt of accept decision is about 258 days. This allows us to publish the latest research quickly before they are outdated. It also relieves authors from the burden of having multiple rounds of long review and revisions.

So, the question is how to ensure the reviews are of high quality while keeping the review cycle short. We are constantly reviewing our editorial and review process to see how this can be improved. We are currently taking some initiatives to improve the process, such as reducing the number of times the paper has to go back to reviewers. We also rely on the associate editors to be a gatekeeper for the review quality. That is why associate editors have a very important role. In addition, we are also constantly reviewing our editorial review board and ensure that this pool of reviewers are dedicated to writing high-quality and timely reviews.

3. Research transparency

Research transparency has become increasingly important. IJIM is committed to research transparency and reproducibility through its Open Data policy. Authors are required to:

- Deposit their research data in a relevant data repository.
- Include appropriate citations and links to these datasets in their article.
- Provide a Research Data Availability Statement.
- If data sharing is not possible due to ethical, legal, or proprietary constraints, authors must include a detailed statement explaining why the research data cannot be shared.

This enables the community to understand how a research study was conducted and replicate it if desired.

4. Looking forward

The world is evolving more quickly than ever. Academic research and the publication process are facing multiple challenges such as the fast growing number of research papers produced, the use of artificial intelligence in research and publication, the rapid advances in science and technology, the publication pressure faced by scholars, just to name a few. As the editors of a high-impact journal, we have the responsibility to publish the best research through the editorial and review process under these challenges. We will do our best to achieve this.

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